



CLIENT CASE STUDY

How **Unrefined Meal Prep** Expanded from Cleveland to Columbus at 4x New Customer ROAS

Northeast Ohio's leading meal prep service entered an entirely new market, and started acquiring new customers at \$20 CPA with \$8-\$10 cost per purchase across scaled ad sets.

Client: Unrefined Meal Prep & Catering **Location:** Cleveland, OH → Columbus, OH

Industry: Meal Prep & Delivery **Service:** Paid Social (Meta Ads)

4x

NEW CUSTOMER ROAS

\$20

NEW CUSTOMER CPA

\$8-\$10

COST PER PURCHASE

~2x

EXPANSION ROAS (MONTH 1)

THE CHALLENGE

Entering a Brand-New Market from Scratch

Unrefined Meal Prep, founded by Riley Tatonetti in Cleveland, Ohio, had established itself as Northeast Ohio's leading meal prep and catering service. Known for 100% gluten-free, seed-oil-free, dietitian-approved meals, the brand had built a dominant position in the Cleveland market. The next step was ambitious: expand into Columbus, Ohio, a city over two hours away where Unrefined had zero brand recognition, zero customers, and zero operational history.

This was not a simple radius expansion. Columbus represented an entirely new market that required building awareness, trust, and a customer base from the ground up.

THE STRATEGY

Dual-Track: Expansion + New Customer Acquisition

We built two parallel campaign structures. The first track was a dedicated Columbus expansion campaign, designed to introduce the Unrefined brand to an entirely new audience and drive first-time orders. The second track was a new customer acquisition campaign in the existing Cleveland market, using exclusion audiences to filter out all previous purchasers.

For the Columbus expansion, we set a clear benchmark: achieve a 2.5x ROAS within the initial launch period. Creative testing and optimization were planned from the outset, with a roadmap to refresh ad creative as the campaign matured.

Meta Ads

Market Expansion

New Customer Acquisition

Exclusion Audiences

Creative Testing

THE RESULTS

Profitable Expansion and Efficient Customer Growth

Both campaign tracks delivered strong results. In the core Cleveland market, the new customer acquisition campaigns consistently delivered 4x ROAS at \$20 CPA — proving the paid media engine is healthy and scalable. The Columbus expansion campaign achieved approximately 2x ROAS in its first month of entering a completely new market with zero brand recognition, approaching the 2.5x target with creative refreshes planned to push performance further.

The screenshot shows the Facebook Ads Manager interface for the campaign 'Unrefined Meal Prep (150...)'. The top navigation bar includes 'Ad sets', 'Value reporting', 'Active ads', 'Had delivery', and '+ 1 more view'. The main content area displays a table of ad sets with columns for 'Off/On', 'Ad set', 'CTR (all)', 'CPC (all)', 'Landing page views', 'Cost per landing pag...', and 'Results ROAS'. Two ad sets are listed: 'New Leads Ad Carousel - Copy Test' and 'New Leads Ad Set Video - Direct Menu - Cop...'. The first ad set has a CTR of 72, CPC of \$1.48, 169 landing page views, a cost per landing page of \$2.38, and a ROAS of 2.01. The second ad set has a CTR of 77, CPC of \$0.81, 40 landing page views, a cost per landing page of \$1.57, and a ROAS of 2.01. The table is filtered by 'Feb 1, 2026 - Feb 28, 2026' and shows 'Results from 2 ad sets'.

Off/On	Ad set	CTR (all)	CPC (all)	Landing page views	Cost per landing pag...	Results ROAS
☒	New Leads Ad Carousel - Copy Test	72	\$1.48	169	\$2.38	2.01
☒	New Leads Ad Set Video - Direct Menu - Cop...	77	\$0.81	40	\$1.57	2.01

~4x

New Customer ROAS, Cleveland

Return on ad spend for campaigns excluding all previous purchasers in the core market.

~\$20

New Customer CPA, Cleveland

Monthly cost to acquire a brand-new customer in the existing market, consistent month over month.

~2x

Expansion ROAS, Columbus

First-month return in a completely new market with zero prior brand presence. Goal: 2.5x.

\$8-\$10

Cost Per Purchase

Achieved across several different ad sets and scaling campaigns in the Cleveland market.

Cleveland vs. Columbus Performance

The dual-market approach allows us to clearly measure the health of the core business alongside the growth trajectory of the new expansion.

MARKET	CAMPAIGN TYPE	ROAS	CPA	STATUS
Cleveland, OH	New Customer Acquisition	~4x	~\$20	Scaling
Cleveland, OH	General Purchase	\$8-\$10 CPP	N/A	Scaling across ad sets
Columbus, OH	Market Expansion	~2x	~\$57	Month 1 (creative refresh planned)

\$8-\$10

Cost Per Purchase Across Scaled Ad Sets

In the core Cleveland market, we are consistently driving purchases at \$8 to \$10 across several different ad creatives and scaling campaigns. This cost efficiency, combined with the 4x ROAS on new customer acquisition at \$20 CPA, demonstrates a healthy and scalable paid media engine. The Columbus expansion, while still in its first month, is already generating a positive return.

CREEKSIDE MARKETING

Ready to expand your meal prep business into new markets?